

PORTFOLIO — 2026

# Theresa Okodede

Product & *Business Strategy*

Turning intelligence into product direction, business decisions and executable strategy.

📍 Nigeria

✉ [theresaokodede@gmail.com](mailto:theresaokodede@gmail.com)

🌐 [linkedin.com/in/theresaokodede](https://www.linkedin.com/in/theresaokodede)



# I work best when the *answer is not obvious yet.*

I use research to understand the problem, commercial judgement to decide what the evidence means and structured execution to move it forward, across product, corporate strategy and African market intelligence.

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**15**

Sub-Saharan markets assessed

**19**

Strategic objectives adopted

**~100**

OKRs structured

**12.58.5**

Epics · stories · phases

**18**

Cross-functional team led

# Three ways I turn a question into a decision.



01

## Product Strategy & Delivery

*Turning ideas into products teams can actually build.*

### EVIDENCE

Investment platform taken from concept note to structured alpha – 12 epics, 58 stories, 5 phases.



02

## Market Intelligence & Growth

*Turning market information into a commercial point of view.*

### EVIDENCE

15-market Sub-Saharan expansion study for an enterprise cloud business.



03

## Corporate Strategy & Execution

*Turning ambition into measurable action.*

### EVIDENCE

19 objectives, ~100 OKRs and 100+ activities now tracked monthly.

# Early-Stage Investment Platform

*Turning an investment idea into a product engineers could actually build.*

## WHAT IT IS

A digital platform that connects early-stage founders with investors — a trusted place for startups to raise money and for investors to find and vet deals.

## WHERE I CAME IN

I joined at the idea stage. There was a concept, but no product plan — no structure, no roadmap and no list of what to build first.

## WHY IT WAS HARD

In investing, simply matching people isn't enough. The product also had to handle trust, identity checks, compliance, investor protection and a clear review process or no one would use it.

## MY ROLE

# Product Lead

I owned the product direction from first concept to the first working version (the “alpha”) — deciding what to build, in what order and making sure the engineering team knew exactly what was needed and why.

FinTech / Startup investing

Concept → Alpha build

# From a rough idea to a staged build plan.

## 01 Understand the problem

Researched founders, investors, competitors and the rules that govern investing.

## 02 Define the product

Wrote the vision, target users and requirements so everyone shared one clear picture.

## 03 Decide the first version

Broke it into 12 epics, 58 user stories and 5 release phases (explained on the right).

## 04 Build with engineers

Managed the build in Jira & GitHub and tested it as work progressed.

## 05 Validate

The alpha is in internal testing; testing with real users is the next step.

### WHAT THE FIRST VERSION (MVP) CONTAINED

12

epics – major feature areas

58

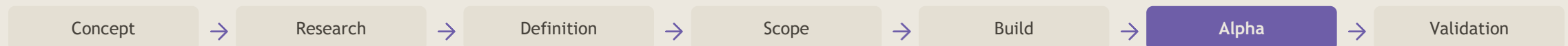
user stories – specific requirements

5

release phases – a staged rollout

*MVP = the smallest version that still keeps the product's core promise. Features were sorted with MoSCoW – a simple must / should / could / won't method.*

### THE JOURNEY



# The strategy behind a whole company.

*Setting one clear, measurable direction across an entire enterprise-technology business.*

## WHAT IT WAS

An established company offering cloud, cybersecurity, connectivity and managed IT services was planning its direction for the year — across several different business lines at once.

## THE TASK

Not just write a strategy document. Understand the market, measure how the business was actually performing, gather the leadership's views and turn all of it into priorities the company could act on and measure.

## MY ROLE

Research & Strategy — I contributed to major parts of the research and the system that turns a strategy into tracked, owned actions.

## HOW I APPROACHED IT

### **Outside-in**

Studied the market — size, competitors, pricing and economic conditions for each service.

### **Inside-out**

Interviewed 10 senior leaders and team members and measured how the business was really performing.

### **Direction**

Turned it into clear objectives, targets and a plan the company could track.

# A plan is only useful if people can act on it.

I helped turn the agreed direction into a live tracking system — showing what the company committed to, who owns each part, and how it is progressing.

GOALS BALANCED ACROSS FOUR AREAS (a “Balanced Scorecard”)

| Financial        | Customer                  | Internal Process   | People & Culture  |
|------------------|---------------------------|--------------------|-------------------|
| Revenue & margin | Winning & keeping clients | Delivery & quality | Team & capability |

*Developed a dashboard then tracks every objective, its owner, timeline, target and status — so progress is visible, not just promised.*

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19

strategic objectives set

~100

OKRs — measurable targets

100+

activities tracked monthly

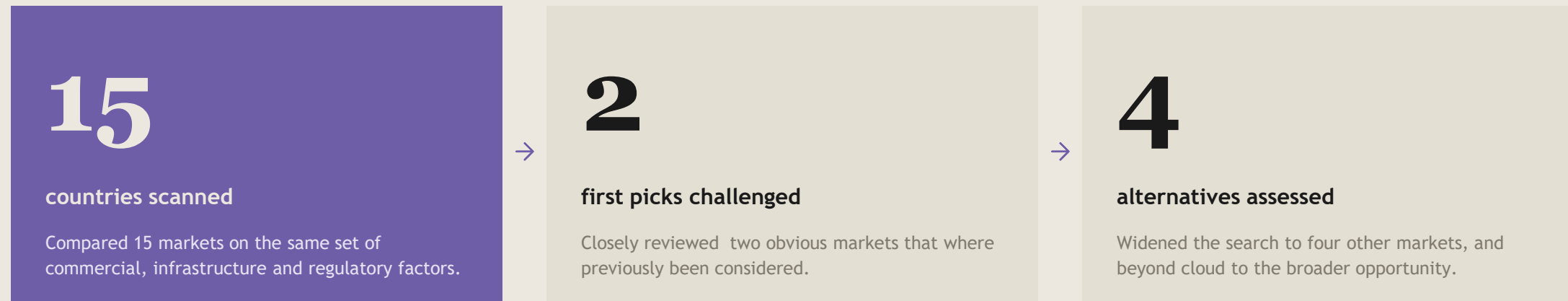
7–10

senior leaders consulted

*Adopted company-wide and reviewed every month.*

# Where should the company grow next?

Management asked a direct question: which African countries should the cloud business expand into? I ran series of the research to answer it — weighing market size, infrastructure, competition and data-sovereignty rules.



The work gave management a clear, like-for-like way to compare markets — and decide where to look deeper.

# SafeScan

*A web app that tells you whether a product's ingredients are safe — in seconds.*

## WHAT IT DOES

Point your phone at an ingredient label (or upload a photo, or type it in) and SafeScan reads it and returns a simple, clear safety rating — no chemistry knowledge needed.

## THE IDEA WAS MINE

I proposed the idea and it was chosen as our team's capstone product for the Women Techsters Fellowship.

## MY ROLE

Product Lead & Product Manager — I led a team of 18 across 7 specialist tracks, from research through to a working product.

## THE PROBLEM · 45 PEOPLE STUDIED

**80%**

found ingredient names too technical



**71.1%**

couldn't tell what was safe or harmful



**55.6%**

had no time to research while shopping



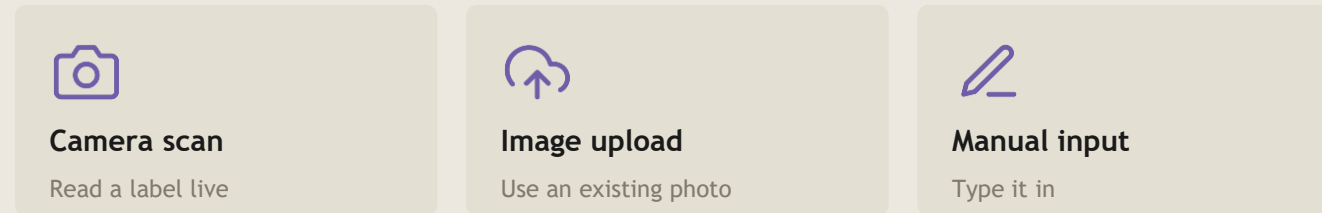
**86.7%**

said they would use a simple safety tool



# Idea to working product in three one-week sprints.

## THREE WAYS TO CHECK A LABEL



## HOW IT WORKS



Research shaped every choice — a web app to check viability of the solution, editable text so users can fix mistakes and simple safety categories instead of jargon.

## WHAT MADE THE 3-WEEK BUILD (prioritised with MoSCoW & Kano)

- ✓ Accurate label reading
- ✓ Ingredient classification
- ✓ Editable text
- ✓ Clear safety results

**18** team members led

**7** specialist tracks

**3** one-week sprints

## BUILT IN THREE SPRINTS

- 1 Foundation
- 2 Integration
- 3 Refinement

*Result: a working product real people can use — built in a short, tightly constrained window.*

# Two shorter projects — where the deliverable was a framework, not a product.



## Enterprise AI & Automation Opportunity Programme

*Contributed to building a framework for discovering opportunities AI, automation or process improvement in a company — before spending money on it.*

### WHAT I DID

Built the method, the scoring system, the governance and the rollout plan.

### WHAT IT PRODUCED

- ✓ A 5-stage operating model
- ✓ A 100-point scoring framework to rank ideas
- ✓ 4 delivery routes
- ✓ Clear ownership & governance

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*Informed decision on building a more robust process transformation documentation, So the business decides what to automate, support with AI, or redesign — before committing engineers.*



## Cloud Partnership & Commercial Strategy Research

*Research to help a cloud provider shape how it partners with others, prices its services and wins customers.*

### WHAT I DID

Benchmarked partner programmes, incentives and the rules, then drew out what it meant.

### WHAT IT PRODUCED

- ✓ Global & regional partner programmes
- ✓ What stops African SMEs adopting cloud
- ✓ Free-to-paid conversion benchmarks
- ✓ Nigeria's data rules & public-sector buying

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*Informed decisions on building the broader partnerships framework, customer acquisition, pricing and staying compliant.*

# The track record behind the work.

EXPERIENCE

## Layer3

Research and Strategy Officer

2026 corporate strategy · 15-market Africa research · execution dashboard.

## StarSector8

Product Dev & Market Research Associate · Product Lead, StellarVest

Vision, MVP scope, roadmap · 12 epics / 58 stories / 5 phases. Nigerian Startup Ecosystem Research

## TrendX

Business Analyst

Product requirements & market research in a DeFi environment.

## Excelerate

Business Consulting Intern

Market, competitor & platform analysis with growth recommendations.



## Product & Strategy

Discovery · MVP scoping · Requirements · Roadmapping · Prioritisation · OKRs · Strategy execution



## Research & Intelligence

Market sizing · Competitive & regulatory analysis · Market-entry · Feasibility · Stakeholder research



## Execution

Cross-functional coordination · Executive reporting · Synthesis · Dashboard reporting

TOOLS

Jira · Trello · GitHub · Excel · Power BI · Odoo · Notion · Whimsical

METHODS

MoSCoW · Kano · RICE · Lean Canvas · Balanced Scorecard · PESTLE · SWOT · Porter's Five Forces



MBA — Miva Open University (in progress)

BSc Agricultural Economics — University of Benin, 2023

LET'S GET TO WORK

# Understand the problem. Make the trade-offs visible. *Build the structure to act.*

If you're facing a problem that isn't fully defined yet, one that needs research, a clear decision and a way to execute — that's the work I want to do with you.

Research & Market Intelligence

Business & Corporate Strategy

Product Strategy & Development

Market Entry & Growth

Business Transformation

✉ Start a conversation [theresaokodede@gmail.com](mailto:theresaokodede@gmail.com)

[linkedin.com/in/theresaokodede](https://www.linkedin.com/in/theresaokodede)

